

~~Secret~~

000732

HEADQUARTERS
SUB-REGION FRANKFURT
COUNTER INTELLIGENCE CORPS REGION III

APD 757

III-FM-6344

4 February 1948

SUMMARY-REPORT OF INVESTIGATION

SUBJECT: Walter and Raimar HORTEN Cross Reference: Flying Saucers

Case Classification: Aircraft Development

1. Reason for Investigation: Reference is made to Letter Headquarters 970th Counter Intelligence Corps Detachment, EUCOM, dated 22 October 1947, file D-198239, Subject: Flying Saucers, in which information is requested regarding the whereabouts and present activities of the HORTEN brothers.

2. Synopsis of Previous Investigation: Previous investigation resulted in a negative report dated 19 November 1947, file and Subject as above.

3. Synopsis of Present Investigation: Egwin LEIBER, former chief engineer of the Gotha Plant, GOTH A (M51/J06) was interviewed on 15 January 1948. LEIBER, born in [REDACTED] was one of the engineers in charge of aeronautical research in the Gotha Plant. From 1935 until 1944 LEIBER received nearly all of the results of the HORTEN brothers' research, which results were checked and compared with research along similar lines. LEIBER stated that two (2) aircraft of the HORTEN IX design were built at the Gotha Plant in 1944, but that further research was necessary before regular production could begin. The war ended before this was completed. It is possible that a copy of the plans are in Russian hands; however the original plans were taken by the Americans in 1945. LEIBER has prepared a report in which he has attempted to reveal what he knows of the HORTEN brothers' work. This report is attached as inclosure 1. From 1929 until 1933 LEIBER worked at the Flugzeugbau, KIEL (L55/C53). From 1933 to 1935 LEIBER worked for Messerschmidt, AUGSBURG (M49/Y37), and from 1935 until 1942 at the Gothaer Waggonfabrik, GOTH A. From 1942 until the end of the war LEIBER worked at the Middledeutsche Metallwerke Flugzeugbau, ERFURT (M51/J36). He was a member of the Lilienthal Institute for Aviation Research and advisor to the Ministry for Aviation. LEIBER claims to have stayed in the Russian Zone until July of 1947 but left because the Soviets began to show an interest in his work and he had no desire to go to Russia. Further details are to be found in inclosure 1. LEIBER also stated that a Dr. Alexander LIPPISCH, who

page 1 of 2 pages

52

copy 1 of 6 copies

~~Secret~~

~~Secret~~

SRE, III-FE-6344, dtd 4 February 48, Subj: Walter and Raimar HORTEN
CONT'D

000733

is at present working at WRIGHT FIELD, Ohio, USA, is also familiar with the work of the HORTEN brothers. LEIBER gives the addresses of the HORTEN family as follows:

Walter HORTEN, Herzbergerstrasse 29a, GOETTINGEN

Raimar HORTEN, at present under contract to the British Government and is living in LONDON

4. Undeveloped Leads: Dr. Alexander LIPPISCH, WRIGHT FIELD, Ohio, and Walter HORTEN, Herzbergerstrasse 39a, GOETTINGEN.

5. Agent's Comments and Conclusions: Arrangements have been made with Mr. CLIPPERT to have LEIBER interrogated further at the 7702 RCIC.

C. Recommendations:

a. It is recommended Inclosure 1 be given to some technical aircraft specialist for translation and analysis.

b. Evaluation: F-6.

APPROVED:

Morris L. Kissinger
MORRIS L. KISSINGER
Special Agent, CIC
Operations Officer

William J. Walsh
WILLIAM J. WALSH
Special Agent, CIC

WOW/vh

Distribution:

5 copies Region III
1 copy rfm files

MAP AND PERS INDEX:

HORTEN, Walter and Raimar
LEIBER, Egwin
LIPPISCH, Dr. Alexander

Incl: 1 - Autobiography of LEIBER

53

~~Secret~~

Page 2 of 2 pages
Copy 2 of 2 copies

REGRADED UNCLASSIFIED
ON 6 JUL 1994
BY CDR USAINSCOM F01/PO
AUTH Para 1-603 DOD 5200.1R